

BUSINESS CASE | JUNE 2026 | AERCHAIN + ADANI GROUP

Procurement at the Speed of Thought

A bottom-up, channel-by-channel case for unlocking ~\$100M in near-term annual value on the Adani Group's ~\$4.0B directly-influenceable spend — the fast-moving slice of a ~\$12B addressable base, itself carved out of a ~\$20B gross procurement engine — by orchestrating AI-native sourcing on top of the existing SAP estate.

GROSS SPEND	ADDRESSABLE SPEND	NEAR-TERM INFLUENCEABLE	PROCUREMENT CYCLES	CATEGORIES
~\$20-22B	~\$12B	~\$4.0B	~300K / yr	140-180
PREPARED FOR	PREPARED BY	CLASSIFICATION		
Adani Group — Group Procurement & CPO Office	Aerchain (Aggilio E-Commerce Private Limited)	Strictly Confidential		

01 Executive summary

Near-term annual value ~\$100M conservative, on ~\$4.0B directly-influenceable spend	Total Year-1 cost ~\$3.75M platform + implementation + Infosys SI	Value / cost ~27-48× on total Y1 cost to platform fee	Payback < 12 mo conservative case clears cost many times over
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Where Adani stands today — and where the near-term value actually sits:

- Already digitally mature.** SAP Ariba + SAP Business Network across ~24 businesses, ~300,000 procurement cycles a year (~100,000 formal POs; the rest catalog, non-PO, tail & invoice events), and ~94% first-time-right digital invoicing.
- The gap isn't digitisation — it's orchestration & judgment at scale.** The value sits in the low-maturity tail, **non-PO & tactical zone**, not the already-digitised strategic core.
- Aerchain layers on top of the SAP estate.** AI-native sourcing compresses cycle times and redirects scarce buyer hours from administrative churn to **high-leverage negotiation** — zero rip-and-replace.
- The prize: ~\$100M/yr** of conservative, bottom-up near-term savings on the ~\$4.0B directly-influenceable slice — with the fuller ~\$12B addressable base carrying multi-year upside, plus stronger compliance, ESG & audit governance.

In one line: a mature-but-manual procurement engine, converted into an autonomous one — ~\$100M of near-term annual value on the ~\$4.0B directly-influenceable slice, against a platform cost of ~\$2.1M/yr.

02 What we heard — Adani today

Credibility first. Adani is **not** a laggard to be fixed — it is a leader to be accelerated. The foundations below are exactly what make an AI-native orchestration layer land quickly and safely.

Digital backbone SAP Ariba + SAP Business Network, ~24 businesses	Procurement cycles / yr ~300K of which ~100K become formal POs	Invoicing quality ~94% first-time-right digital invoicing	Tier-1 suppliers 7,865 ~35% MSME / local sourcing
THE ESTATE ERP landscape: 14 + 1B SAP S/4HANA instances Sourcing / P2P: SAP Ariba + SAP Business Network Businesses: ~24 Employees: 35-40K Categories: 140-180	THE MANDATE SIGNALS Annual spend: \$20-22B (~\$36-38B revenue) MSME / local: ~35% ESG: Supplier ESG screening in place Coal exposure: >60% Complex-cat P2P: ~24-day median cycle*		

02.1 Mandate mirror — Adani priorities map directly to Aerchain modules

Every stated Adani priority has a one-to-one Aerchain capability. Nothing here requires re-platforming.

ADANI PRIORITY Standardise sourcing across 24 businesses without ripping out SAP	Aerchain S2P orchestration layer Sits on SAP Ariba / S/4HANA — zero rip-and-replace , one playbook across BUs
ADANI PRIORITY Apply scarce buyer time only where judgment adds value	Autonomous & Guided Sourcing AI runs tail & tactical events end-to-end — ~60% of buyer week returned to strategy
ADANI PRIORITY Get faster, more defensible savings on coal, fuel & EPC	Strategic Sourcing + Cleansheet / e-Auction Should-cost + auctions at scale on ~\$4.0B addressable strategic spend (EPC, heavy equipment, non-fuel logistics & services)
ADANI PRIORITY Control tail spend & off-contract leakage	Catalog + Self-Service PO + Tail automation Maverick ~35-45% + ~10% via guided buying
ADANI PRIORITY Onboard & risk-screen 7,865 suppliers faster	AI Vendor Onboarding & Due Diligence Onboarding cycle ~90%, automated risk / ESG at entry
ADANI PRIORITY Support the coal-transition & decarbonisation agenda	ESG Screening + Immutable Audit Ledger ESG scoring at onboarding (~90% compliance, full audit trail)

03 The opportunity — where the value is

Not every dollar of the ~\$20B is a sourcing lever. Before modelling savings, we carve the gross spend down to what is genuinely **addressable & influenceable** — and hold the commodity / captive remainder to a separate, non-savings-percentage value lens.

03.1 Addressable-spend waterfall

Gross procurement is discounted for spend that a sourcing platform cannot move on price — index-linked commodity & fuel, and intra-group / related-party transfers — leaving the base on which savings percentages are actually applied.

SPEND LAYER	AMOUNT	RUNNING BASE	SAVINGS LEVER
Gross procurement	\$20.0B	\$20.0B	—
less Commodity & fuel pass-through coal / LNG / fuel — index-linked, long-term-contracted, partly captive	~\$7.0B	\$13.0B	cycle-time / benchmarking / compliance only
less Intra-group / related-party captive transfers, not open-market sourceable	~\$1.0B	\$12.0B	governance / audit only
Addressable & influenceable spend	~\$12.0B	\$12.0B	multi-year base
less Strategic core & multi-year categories already-digitised strategic sourcing (EPC, heavy equipment) & services/RC — longer, multi-year savings cycles	~\$8.0B	\$4.0B	multi-year upside, not near-term headline
Directly-influenceable, near-term slice	~\$4.0B	\$4.0B	the savings-model base

Why this matters: the ~\$8B of commodity & captive spend is **excluded from the savings-percentage model** — index-linked, long-term-contracted or intra-group, so a sourcing platform does not move its unit price. The headline savings model then narrows further, to the ~\$4.0B Aerchain **directly-influences first** (tactical sourcing, tail & non-PO, and indirect / catalog) — the fast-moving, near-term-capturable slice. The remaining ~\$8.0B of the addressable base (strategic core, services/RC) carries **additional multi-year upside** as coverage widens, but is deliberately held out of the near-term headline. Every headline savings figure in this case is applied to the ~\$4.0B near-term slice, never the full \$12B or \$20B.

The gross-spend map below shows where the dollars sit across all channels (pre-carve-out); the savings model in Section 04 works strictly on the ~\$4.0B directly-influenceable, near-term slice.

CHANNEL	% OF SPEND	~\$ VALUE	% OF TXNS
Strategic Sourcing (RFx / negotiated) Structured RFx, high value, low volume	35%	~\$7.0B	~12%
Tactical Sourcing (guided RFQ) Repeatable mid-value buys	20%	~\$4.0B	~18%
Catalog / Self-Service PO Punch-out & requisition-to-PO	20%	~\$4.0B	~34%
Non-PO / Services / RC Recurring & services invoices	15%	~\$3.0B	~22%
Tail (~\$50K, ad-hoc / local) Long-tail, one-off, local buys	10%	~\$2.0B	~14%
Total	100%	~\$20B	100%

The Pareto / long-tail hook: roughly 20% of spend generates close to ~80% of transactions in the tactical-and-tail zone. Today, expensive strategic-buyer hours are consumed processing low-value, high-frequency events. Aerchain reverses this **procurement effort applied selectively where human judgment creates the most value**, with AI orchestrating the high-volume remainder autonomously.

COAL / LNG / FUEL 45% of spend — the strategic prize	CAPITAL PROJECTS / EPC 25% \$5-6.5B capital book; speed = value	INDIRECT + SERVICES + TAIL 30% Indirect 18% / services/RC 7% / tail 5%
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04 The savings model (bottom-up)

Modelled **channel-by-channel on the ~\$4.0B directly-influenceable, near-term slice** (not the full \$12B addressable base, and never the \$20B gross), across the three channels Aerchain automates and drives savings on first. Percentages are deliberately conservative. The sum is the headline near-term value. The broader ~\$12B addressable base carries **additional multi-year upside** as strategic categories and renewals come into scope — excluded here to keep the headline defensible.

CHANNEL	SPEND	SAVINGS %	ANNUAL SAVINGS
Tactical Sourcing Guided RFQ / competition replacing ad-hoc, single-source buys	\$2.0B	2-4%	\$40-80M
Tail & Non-PO Autonomous events + consolidation + off-contract recovery	\$1.0B	4-6%	\$40-60M
Indirect / Catalog compliance Catalog & guided buying — maverick reduction on indirect spend	\$1.0B	2%	\$20M
Total — near-term annual value (directly-influenceable)	\$4.0B	~2.5-4.0%	\$100M-160M

Read it as: a conservative anchor of ~\$100M (scaling to ~\$160M at the upper end of the modelled rates) in bottom-up, near-term-capturable annual value on the ~\$4.0B directly-influenceable slice — modelled channel-by-channel. These savings **compound and expand across years** as contracts renew on improved baselines, catalog coverage widens, and autonomous coverage climbs from Wave 1 to Wave 3 into the broader ~\$12B addressable base.

04.1 Sensitivity — conservative / base / upside

Three scenarios on the same ~\$4.0B directly-influenceable slice, flexing the blended realised savings rate. Realisation carries execution risk (adoption, data readiness, wave sequencing) — but even the conservative case dwarfs the cost.

SCENARIO	INFLUENCEABLE SLICE	BLENDED RATE	ANNUAL VALUE
Conservative slower adoption, partial wave coverage	\$4.0B	~2.5%	~\$100M
Base planned rollout, expected realisation	\$4.0B	~3.25%	~\$130M
Upside full coverage, baselines reset on renewal	\$4.0B	~4.0%	~\$160M

Realisation-risk note: value ramps with the wave rollout and is not realised in full on day one — expect ~30% of steady-state in Year 1, ~70% in Year 2, and 100% by Year 3. Even so, the **conservative ~\$100M** case still exceeds the ~\$3.75M total Year-1 investment by ~27+ — the downside case remains overwhelmingly positive.

05 Double-click: the benefits, decomposed

This is the core of the document. Each benefit is decomposed at three altitudes — (a) **Mechanism** (how the AI achieves it), (b) **Resource & time analysis** (where the hours/days go, today vs. after), and (c) **Calculation + \$ value & ROI** (baseline + improved + delta + dollars).

05.1 Hard-dollar category savings

Three marquee channels carry the near-term hard-dollar case, all on the ~\$4.0B directly-influenceable slice. Each is a "today vs. with Aerchain" delta driven by a specific AI mechanism.

Where the gains actually live: Adani already runs ~94% first-time-right and a mature Ariba backbone — so the efficiency upside is **not** in the already-digitised strategic core. It sits in the **tail, non-PO and tactical zone**: low process maturity, high transaction volume, and the bulk of off-contract leakage. That is where guided buying and autonomous events convert manual, unmanaged activity into governed, competed spend.

1 Tactical Sourcing — guided RFQ / competition Tactical: ~\$2.0B directly-influenceable spend / driver: playbook-driven competition replacing ad-hoc buys	2 Tail & Non-PO — leakage recovery Tail + Non-PO: ~\$1.0B directly-influenceable / driver: autonomous events + consolidation + off-contract recovery	3 Indirect / Catalog compliance — maverick reduction Indirect: ~\$1.0B directly-influenceable / driver: catalog & guided buying compliance
TODAY Mid-value buys are placed locally — often single-source, often on last price. Buyers lack time to run a proper 3-bid RFQ, so competitive tension is left on the table across thousands of events a year. ~1% COMPETITION CAPTURED	TODAY Low-volume, low-maturity zone — minimal oversight. Off-contract and maverick buying runs rampant; off-contract spend is intercepted and routed to catalog/negotiated rates. Maverick falls negotiated rates entirely. 35-45% MAVERICK / OFF-CONTRACT	TODAY Indirect and MRO requisitions bypass catalogs and negotiated rates; the same SKU is bought at inconsistent prices across BUs, and off-catalog buying leaks contracted discounts. LOW CATALOG COMPLIANCE
WITH AERCHAIN A guided-RFQ playbook auto-drafts the event, invites qualified vendors, and normalises bids — making a competitive 3+ bid the default path, not the exception. Buyers approve, not assemble. 2-4% + \$40-80M / YR Playbook-driven guided RFQ	WITH AERCHAIN Autonomous sourcing runs tail events without a buyer; demand is consolidated to contracted vendors; off-contract spend is intercepted and routed to catalog/negotiated rates. Maverick falls below 10%. 4-6% + \$40-60M / YR Autonomous events + leakage recovery	WITH AERCHAIN Guided buying steers every indirect requisition to catalog and contracted rates; off-catalog attempts are intercepted at the point of demand and re-routed. Catalog compliance rises sharply. 2% + \$20M / YR Catalog + guided-buying compliance

Near-term total: \$40-80M (tactical) + \$40-60M (tail & non-PO) + ~\$20M (indirect / catalog) = \$100M-160M (conservative anchor ~\$100M) — the entire near-term headline comes from these three directly-influenceable channels. Strategic sourcing (EPC, heavy equipment) sits in the broader ~\$12B addressable base as **multi-year upside**, above this figure.

06 Additional benefits — directional, not committed

Beyond the three hard-dollar levers, the platform creates operational, capacity and control value. The figures below are **indicative and directional** — shown to convey mechanism and magnitude, **not booked into the headline case and not committed as outcomes**. Every one is validated against Adani's own baselines during rollout.

Read this as **capability, not commitment**. Nothing here is summed into the ~\$100M sourcing headline — each is an additional, directional benefit, sized on your data once live.

06.1 Cycle-time reduction — indicative ~40% on complex sourced categories

MECHANISM Scoped to **complex sourced categories** (structured RFx / negotiated events). AI generates RFx from templates and prior awards in hours not days; OCR-parses and normalises incoming offers to a common schema, scores each vendor against technical & commercial criteria; and auto-routes approvals / NFAs instead of email chase.

RESOURCE & TIME The saved days come out of **buyer / category-manager hours and approver wait-time**. A complex event that ties up a buyer across ~24 elapsed days clears in ~14 — freeing the buyer's active hours and the queue behind them. The **~24-day baseline is indicative, to be validated on Adani's data**.

CALC + TIME Baseline median **~24 days*** + improved **~14 days = ~10 days (~40%)**. On a **\$5-5.5B capital-projects book**, faster award pulls capex mobilisation forward and releases working capital tied up in stalled projects.

Where the ten days come from — stage by stage:

STAGE	TODAY	AERCHAIN	DELTA
RFx drafting & scoping AI generation from templates + prior events	5 days	1 day	~4 days
Offer extraction & normalisation OCR + AI parsing to a common schema	3 days	0.5 days	~2.5 days
Technical + commercial evaluation Per-vendor AI scoring vs. criteria	6 days	4 days	~2 days
Clarifications & negotiation AI drafts; buyer decides	5 days	5 days	0 days
Approvals / NFA routing Auto-routing vs. manual chase	5 days	3.5 days	~1.5 days
Complex sourced-category P2P median	~24 days*	~14 days	~40%

*Indicative, scoped to complex sourced categories; to be validated on Adani's data.

06.2 Buyer capacity / productivity — the buyer week, reallocated

MECHANISM Autonomous and guided sourcing absorb the tail and tactical admin that consumes most of a buyer's week. AI drafts RFx, normalises offers, scores vendors and chases approvals — so the buyer's hours shift from **assembling** events to **deciding and negotiating** them.

RESOURCE & TIME Reallocating the buyer week: tail / admin **55% + 12%**, supplier ops **25% + 8%**, tactical **10% + 20%**, strategic **10% + 60%**. Strategic time rises ~6+ as a share — the practical effect is **2-3+ strategic throughput** per buyer and ~+35% overall productivity.

CALC + CAPACITY Group sourcing org = 250 FTEs (illustrative — **to be validated with Adani's actual team size**). 250 FTE x (2-3+ strategic throughput ~ 1) = **~250-500 FTE-equivalent** of added strategic capacity — **without hiring**. An **alternative lens, not additive** to the hard-dollar savings — the freed hours are the mechanism that captures those savings, so the two are never summed.

The buyer week, reallocated:

Tail / admin processing Tactical buying Supplier ops & expediting Strategic sourcing	TODAY — THE BUYER WEEK only ~10% on strategy 55% 10% 25% 10%	WITH AERCHAIN — THE BUYER WEEK ~60% on strategy 12% 20% 8% 60%
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The **capacity unlock** ~250-500 FTE-equivalent of added strategic capacity — unlocked without a single net-new hire. Capacity, not cost, becomes the constraint Aerchain removes. An alternative lens on the same value, not a line added to the savings total.

07 More benefits, in brief

TAIL & MAVERICK CONTROL Maverick 35-45% + ~10% Guided buying intercepts off-contract spend at the point of demand; autonomous events run the long tail; consolidation across 7,865 tier-1 suppliers compounds it. Indicative.	VENDOR ONBOARDING Onboarding 4-6 wks + 2-3 wks AI collects & validates documents and runs due-diligence, sanctions & ESG checks at entry — faster, safer supplier activation; supports the ~39% MSME / local agenda. Indicative ~50%.	COMPLIANCE, GOVERNANCE & ESG Policy enforced in-flow Guided buying + approval matrices enforce policy before spend, not in a post-audit; an immutable, tamper-evident ledger across ~100K tons; ESG screening at onboarding for the coal-transition agenda. One avoided breach can exceed the platform fee.
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07 ROI & payback

The investment case is asymmetric — but stated honestly and **net of cost**. We size the return against the **total Year-1 investment (~\$3.75M)**, not just the platform run-rate, and we ramp the value with the wave rollout rather than assuming full realisation on day one.

COMPONENT	AMOUNT	NOTE
Platform run-rate (SaaS) annual subscription	~\$2.1M	recurring
Aerchain implementation config, integration, rollout	~\$1.15M	Year 1
Infosys SI systems-integration partner	~\$0.5M	Year 1
Total Year-1 Investment	~\$3.75M	platform + impl. + SI

Realisation ramp — value scales with the wave rollout. It is not realised in full on day one:

PERIOD	% OF STEADY-STATE	VALUE REALISED	COVERAGE
Year 1 Wave 1 — tail, ramp-up	~30%	~\$30M	early adoption
Year 2 Wave 2 — indirect + tactical	~70%	~\$70M	scaling
Year 3 — steady state	100%	~\$100M	full coverage

STEADY-STATE VS. PLATFORM ~\$100M conservative value vs. ~\$2.1M platform run-rate	STEADY-STATE VS. TOTAL Y1 ~\$100M conservative value vs. ~\$3.75M total Year-1 investment	PAYBACK even Year-1 ramped value (~\$30M) clears the ~\$3.75M cost many times over
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THE VALUE-TO-COST RATIO — NET & HONEST
 ~\$3.75M_{Y1} Total Year-1 investment platform + impl. + Infosys SI
 ~\$100M_{Yr} Near-term annual value (conservative, ~\$4.0B directly-influenceable)
 ~27-48× Value dwarfs cost (~2% on total Y1, ~48+ on platform)
 Bottom line — steady-state value vs. total Year-1 cost
~\$100M vs. \$3.75M

The cost is a fraction of the value — and it holds up under scrutiny: even measured against the full ~\$3.75M Year-1 spend (not just the platform) and even in the conservative ~\$100M scenario, the total Year-1 cost is under ~4% of the near-term annual value at stake (the platform fee alone, ~\$2.1M, is ~2.1%). This is not a cost decision — it is a capacity-to-core decision.

08 Ariba cost-takeout — the platform is self-funding

As Aerchain absorbs **sourcing and vendor onboarding**, Adani can **progressively retire or downsize Ariba modules** — Sourcing, SLP / supplier-management, and some Ariba Network supplier fees — while Ariba remains for what it does best (its P2P / network backbone) during transition. All Ariba figures below are **indicative and to be validated against Adani's actual Ariba contract**.

ITEM	BASIS	INDICATIVE \$ (TO BE VALIDATED)
Total current Ariba subscription	Full stack — Sourcing, SLP / supplier-management, P2P and Ariba Network — for a ~\$20B spend enterprise.	~\$5M / yr
Retire-able footprint	Sourcing + SLP / supplier-management + some Ariba Network supplier fees — the modules Aerchain assumes; the P2P / network backbone is retained during transition.	~\$3-4M / yr
Realistic progressive take-out	retire / downsize as Aerchain takes over sourcing & onboarding — more than fully offsets the Aerchain platform fee	~\$2.5-3.5M / yr

Net funding effect: a discretionary Ariba take-out of ~\$2.5-3.5M/yr **more than fully offsets** the ~\$2.1M Aerchain platform run-rate — so the platform is **self-funding from retired incumbent spend, with a net saving of ~\$0.4-1.4M/yr on top**. All Ariba figures are INDICATIVE / to-be-validated with Adani's actual Ariba contract.

08 Why Aerchain — not Ariba / Coupa / GEP

The incumbents digitised procurement. Aerchain **automates the judgment** on top of it — and does so without asking Adani to unwind its SAP investment.

AI-native, not bolted-on Aerchain was built AI-first — autonomous sourcing, cleansheet, and offer normalisation are core, not add-on modules retrofitted onto a legacy P2P suite.	Why not SAP Joule / Ariba's own AI? Joule and Ariba's embedded AI are assistant / copilot layers bolted onto a system of record — they summarise, suggest and answer questions. They do not run the procurement cycle autonomously (agentic intake + RFx + offer-extraction + negotiation + award + match). Aerchain is AI-native and outcome-owning (sits on top of the existing estate across all 14+1B instances and any ERP — not locked to one SAP release or roadmap cycle — and delivers autonomy today, not on SAP's roadmap.
Full suite + autonomous depth One platform spans strategic, tactical, autonomous, catalog, self-service PO, non-PO and RC invoice — with genuine autonomous-sourcing depth not just workflow.	SAP-native, sits on your estate Runs on top of SAP Ariba, Business Network and S/4HANA. Zero rip-and-replace — Adani's 14+1B-instance estate stays.
Proven at conglomerate scale Deployed group-wide at a peer Indian conglomerate and across large multinational manufacturers — complexity and scale comparable to the Adani portfolio. Aggregate footprint: 45+ enterprises, \$45B+ spend processed, 150K+ suppliers.	

The distinction: Ariba / Coupa / GEP are systems of record. Aerchain is a **system of action** that sits on the record you already have — which is precisely why it lands fast on Adani's existing estate.

09 In summary

THE CASE IN ONE FRAME

A conservative **~\$100M a year** — on spend Adani already owns, captured on top of the SAP estate you already run.

Three defensible levers on the ~\$4.0B directly-influenceable slice — self-funding against the Ariba take-out, with multi-year upside across the fuller ~\$12B addressable base, and **zero rip-and-replace**.

~\$100M_{Yr}
 Conservative near-term value on the ~\$4.0B influenceable slice

~27-48×
 Value / cost
 payback < 12 months

Self-funding
 Ariba take-out exceeds the ~\$2.1M platform fee

The single message

Adani built the rails — Aerchain runs the trains at the speed of thought.